

Sharing has been left on or the personal firewall is misconfigured, a hacker can readily access your PC and hard drive across the wireless network. Firewalls are also easy to misconfigure or turn off, and forget to turn back on. With older versions of Windows (NT, W2K), if improperly configured, it's easy prey for a hacker to get in over the network, log-in as a null session and take over your platform.

Deadly Attack #4: Access To The Corporate Network

If your wireless network is connected to a corporate network through a site-to-site VPN, an open wireless network punches a hole through the network, and opens up both sides of the VPN to anyone attaching to the network. Another threat is with improperly configured client VPNs which can be more easily compromised to provide the hacker access through the VPN.

Deadly Attack #5: Spam And Virus Launching Over The Wireless Network

Unsecured Networks provide are an ideal launch point from which hackers can launch spam and virus attacks because it is very difficult to track the source back to them. From a distance, the spammer can launch the spam (from your e-mail account if he sniffed your e-mail account info) without repudiation. When the ISP or FBI tracks down the violator, the trail points to your network, and possibly your e-mail account. The liabilities to the owner of the unsecured network are still newly contended battlegrounds for the lawyers.

Best Practices To Secure Your Wireless Network

The good news is that simple tools are available to properly secure your wireless network and avoid the dangers discussed above.

The Wi-Fi Alliance designated WPA (Wi-Fi Protected Access) as the recommended security practices for consumer and business networks. WPA comes in two forms: WPA-PSK, which offers a lower-level security for consumers, and WPA-Enterprise, which